

Your Chabad Yom Kippur Companion



**The Jewish soul
A simple thing
At one with G-d
In everything.**

- Simcha Wasserman

PRACTICAL YOM KIPPUR

KEY TIMES

Kol Nidrei
6:00 p.m.

Shacharis
9:00 a.m.

Yizkor
11:30 a.m.

Mincha
4:00 p.m.

Neilah
5:00 p.m.

Fast ends
6:37 p.m.



DON'Ts:

- Eating
- Drinking
- Washing (no showers, we don't even wash our hands properly, only till the knuckles- except the kohanim before they bless us).
- Anointing (no perfume/ cologne, creams etc.)

- Couple's intimacy (not even a hug & definitely no hugging someone else's spouse, although that's not kosher all year 'round).
- Leather shoes (belts are fine, best not to bring a handbag on Yom Tov).
- Gold (too close to the Golden Calf for comfort...)



DO's:

- White clothing (men wear a kittel)
- Lots of Tehillim
- Learning about the Yom Kippur service in the Temple
- A self-audit. Teshuvah is all about confronting the nasties of our personality and taking real action to become better.

“The primary distinguishing feature which sets the human being apart from all other creatures is the free choice of action which the Creator bestowed upon us.

We can use this Divine gift either for self-destruction and the destruction of everything around us; or we can choose the right way of life, which would elevate ourselves and our environment to the highest possible perfection.”

KOL NIDREI

What's it all about

Everybody goes to Shul for Kol Nidrei. Its haunting melodies stir the soul and zone you in to the feeling that the “Big Day” Yom Kippur has begun.

Interestingly, Kol Nidrei is really just an annulment of vows. You'd have expected something deep & spiritual, considering the hype, but it turns out to be not much more than an apology for not living up to our undertakings.

Or, you could see a different angle:

Each of us lives a narrative we've repeated to ourselves so often that we believe it absolutely. We tell ourselves we're disorganised, short-tempered, not-the-spiritual-type, recurrent failures or self-absorbed. After repeating our story enough times, we “promise” ourselves that our habits and failings are here to stay.

Step one of the transformational Yom Kippur experience is to “annul” and let go of our personal negative narrative. Yom Kippur is the time to free ourselves from our self-promise that we cannot change. Kol Nidrei is the escape hatch; on Yom Kippur anything is possible.

5 Prayers:

There are five prayers over Yom Kippur- relating to the five levels of our Soul.
Yom Kippur is the day you can access all five levels.



HOW TO

Shehecheyanu

There's no Kiddush tonight, so we say this blessing in Shul- together.

We normally say “**Baruch Shem...**” (the second line of the Shema) quietly.
On Yom Kippur, we say it aloud.

Moses originally heard this prayer from the angels when he was on Mount Sinai and brought it back down with him. He told the Israelites to always read it quietly, because it was spiritual “contraband”. Thus we say it quietly all year round. But on Yom Kippur we are likened to the angels and have no reason to hide the fact that we use this special prayer.

Beat it!

Each time we say the confession (Ashamnu or Al Cheit), we will tap our chests with one of our fists. We usually do the wrong things in a burst of emotion, passion or anger. A knock on the chest should remind us to use our minds to keep our hearts in check in future.

Read along

We only do Yom Kippur once a year. Wherever you can, try read along, even in English (after all, G-d understands all languages).

Winning team:

Two people hold Torah scrolls on either side of the Chazan, during Kol Nidrei.

They recall how Moses, Aaron & Chur stood overlooking Joshua's successful battle against Amalek.

FOCAL POINTS

Loud 'n clear:

Remember: Yom Kippur is the only time of the year that we read the second line of the *Shema* aloud.

Shema (P44)

This is Judaism's most well-known prayer. *Shema* evokes the deep-seated faith in G-d that each of us always has, but sometimes forgets about.

By saying the *Shema*, we not only declare that there is only one G-d, but that there is literally nothing else besides G-d. G-d is one. G-d is everything. G-d is in charge. Most importantly, G-d is good.

We cover our eyes with our right hand (unless you're left-handed) for the first line of the *Shema* to block out any distractions, and to help us go inward.

The Amidah (P47)

"*Amidah*" means "standing". We stand at attention for this entire prayer. The blessings in the *Amidah* date back to Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, although the final form was arranged over 2000 years ago by the Rabbis of the Great Assembly.

The *Amidah* is the central part of the service, it's said every day of the year and is divided into three sections: Praise, petition and thanksgiving.

Praise: The first three blessings recognize G-d's greatness. We approach as children of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, We acknowledge that to G-d is kind, supports the fallen and heals the sick.

Petition: The middle segments express the Holiness of the day. This includes prayers for the whole world to recognize G-d's greatness (and to behave appropriately) and for the restoration of Jerusalem.

Thanksgiving: Having concluded our requests, we close the *Amidah* with gratitude to G-d for everything He has given and will give us.

Ya'aleh (P58)

There's an old Yiddish saying: "May G-d helps us! And, until He helps us, may He help us as well". In that vein, before we start the unique Yom Kippur prayers, that will last for 24-hours, we ask G-d to please listen to- and accept- all of our prayers.

3 Steps:

We start the *Amidah* by taking three steps backwards & three steps forward, symbolically approaching the King of Kings to pray.

"Chassidim would say: Better an old villager than a young genius. G-d is not impressed by those born with talent, but rather by those who work to become better people."

Ki hiney kachomer (P66)

It's only natural: We believe our success to be our own. We also believe our failures to be our own. Either belief could stray into unhealthy thinking-arrogance on the one hand, depression on the other.

Yom Kippur is a time to reset our perspectives. We are merely clay in G-d's hands. Sure, each of us is endowed with talents, potential and opportunities, but realistically, it is G-d who determines whether or not we get to enjoy them.

Yom Kippur is a reality-check. It reminds us to be humble and grateful for our achievements, as it reminds us to feel confident and motivated to overcome our shortcomings.

Al Chet (P73)

Throughout Yom Kippur, we confess a long-list of wrongdoings, some of which may sound familiar, others which you would never dream of doing.

Judaism doesn't believe in confessing our sins to other people. *Al Chet* is between each of us and G-d. It is a silent, reflective process of admitting our faults and planning to improve upon them in the coming year. All growth, no matter how small, is valuable.

Code Forgive:

You will hear "Hashem, Hashem" a.k.a. the "Thirteen Attributes of Mercy" repeated again and again over Yom Kippur. This is the secret code that G-d gave Moses to use whenever we need atonement. It comes with 100% guarantee.

When the Rabbi Menachem Mendel, the third of Lubavitch (known as the Tzemach Tzedek) was ten years old, he once stepped out of Shul for a moment on Yom Kippur. When he returned, someone had accidentally taken his machzor.

Seeing this, one of the Chassidim offered to share his machzori with the young boy, but the Tzemach Tzedek refused.

"Your *al chet* confession and mine are not the same," he explained.

When his grandfather, the Alter Rebbe later heard about this, he commented: "He is right, the regular *al chet* is a matter of confession, my grandson's *al chet* is a process of cleansing (he referred to the expression "*vechitesa*", where the verse speaks of cleansing the altar).

MORNING SESSION (A.K.A. SHACHARIS)

Hamelech (P135)

The main section of the morning service starts with the loud cry of “Hamelech” – “O KING”.

As we say that one word, the mystics teach, all accusers flee from G-d’s throne of judgment... It is like when a captive being dragged past the palace screams out “O KING” his captors fear the king’s wrath and flee in panic.

Shir HaMaalos (P136)

Written by King David, this prayer evokes G-d’s forgiveness. It opens with “from the depth of my heart I call to you” – our prayers should not be superficial mumblings, but rather an exercise of the heart and soul.

The Shema (P141)

Rabbi Levi Yitzchak of Berditchev said: In our prayers, we say, “G-d, guardian of Israel, protect Israel... who say “*Shema Yisrael*”. Even a Jew who only says the *Shema*, once a year on Yom Kippur, deserves G-d’s protection.

The Amidah (P145)

One of the greatest ideals of Judaism is to become a dedicated servant of G-d. When the Jews stood at Mt. Sinai, it was their unquestioning dedication to fulfill G-d’s laws that earned them the Torah and the unique position of “Chosen People”.

The High Holidays are meant to be the time to ramp up our dedication to G-d, to commit ourselves even more strongly to following His instructions.

The way that we stand, with our feet together, at attention, during the *Amidah* is meant to awaken in us a sense of being “at the ready” to do as G-d wants.

Next Gen:

During the *Shema*, the time of deep connection with G-d, we read of the need to pass on a healthy knowledge of Judaism to our children.

Dry Bones MODERN TIMES



SHACHARIS REPETITION

Moreh Chatoim (P160)

This lengthy "*piyut*" (liturgical prayer) contains the double acrostic, Meshullam son of Rabbi Klonymos, may he be strong. He was born in 950 CE in Lucca, Italy and died in 1020 in Mainz, Germany. Rabbi Meshullam composed a number of the liturgical poetry used in the High Holiday services.

This one combines a few themes: Acknowledging G-d's greatness and Israel's age-old loyalty to Him, our hope for forgiveness, and our expectations of the Messianic Redemption.

Here's another interesting theme: Intertwined in this *piyut* are snatches from Psalm 145, the *Ashrei*. The Talmud teaches that whoever says *Ashrei* properly 3 times a day is guaranteed a share in the World to Come. So, we mix *Asheri* in here for extra-strength prayers for forgiveness.

Al Yisrael (P169)

This *piyut* follows the order of the Hebrew alphabet. It depicts G-d's special relationship with us. Some sections describe the various blessings that G-d gives us (majesty, purity, pleasantness), others describes how certain facets of the world depend upon our performance of the commandments.

All in it together:

We say all the confessions in plural, because every Jew is responsible for the physical & spiritual wellbeing of every other Jew.

Three phase:

The confessions use three terms: "*Selach*" for minor sins, "*Mechal*" for sins we gained personal benefit from, "*Kapper*" for sins we don't even realise we did (and so find it hard to atone for).



Makes you think...

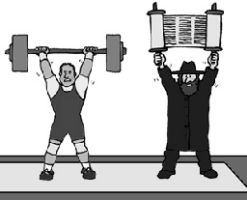
One of our "confessions" on Yom Kippur is for: "the sin which we committed against you unwillingly or willingly."

Hang on? Unwillingly? Why would we have to atone for the times we simply couldn't help ourselves?

Well, Judaism believes that we are far stronger than we imagine. Each of us has the tools to beat any temptation that comes our way. We need to recognize our abilities- and use them.

After a person does in an internal audit during the days of Elul, Rosh Hashanah, the Ten Days of Repentance, and the eve of Yom Kippur, he or she begins to understand that even mistakes amount to a lack of resolve...

TORAH READING



Today's Torah reading covers the details of what happened in the Temple on Yom Kippur, as well as some of the key laws of Yom Kippur.

Most of this information is spelled out in detail during the Musaf service.

Section 1 (Kohen's *aliyah*): Aaron's sons have just passed away after performing an unauthorised service in the newly built Sanctuary in the desert. Following that tragedy, G-d warns that only the High Priest (a.k.a. *Kohen Gadol*) may enter the inner sanctum (the Holy of Holies) where the Ark is housed- and only on Yom Kippur.

Section 2 (Levi's *aliyah*): Here we read further details of the Yom Kippur service. The High Priest had to change between his ordinary white kohen uniform and the special "golden" garments reserved for the High Priest. Interestingly, he would wear only the simple white outfit when entering the Holy of Holies, because humility and simplicity bring you close to G-d.

Section 3: The High Priest had to bring a special incense into the Holy of Holies, as well as various animal offerings. In this piece, we also read how G-d promises to always forgive us and remain with us, even when we sin.

Section 4: Aaron, the High Priest, would make a public confession on behalf of the whole nation. He would then send a goat into the desert to be thrown off a cliff.

Section 5: Aaron would burn the fat of the sin-offering, which symbolizes destroying our enthusiasm and excitement for the forbidden.

Here we read how G-d allocates the 10th of Tishrei as Yom Kippur (This is the same date that Moshe returned from Mount Sinai with the second set of Tablets and informed the people that G-d had forgiven them for the sin of the Golden Calf.)

Section 6: One may not work on Yom Kippur, just like on Shabbos, plus we are instructed to "afflict" our souls. The oral law defines afflicting one's soul as abstaining from eating, washing, anointing, wearing leather shoes and marital intimacy. We are also told that this Yom Kippur Temple service may only be performed by a High Priest, not even by an ordinary Kohen.

HAFTORAH: After the Prophet Isaiah gives the Jewish people hope, he urges us to return to G-d through good deeds, kindness and sincere teshuvah. Fasting alone is not enough, the trick is to be enthusiastic about reconnecting with G-d.

Up, up & away:
Aaron's sons were so keen to connect with G-d, that their enthusiasm led them into a spiritual yearning that their bodies couldn't sustain.

Motivation is great, but growth must be pragmatic & grounded.

MUSAF

Zachreinu L'Chaim (P215)

Between Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur we add small requests in the Amidah for G-d to bless us with life and goodness in the New Year. This short addition "remember us" contains eleven words. Eleven is the mystical number of impurity, which is associated with forgetfulness. Here, we want to eradicate forgetfulness, always remember to do as G-d says and hope that He "remembers" us for good always.

The moving prayer of "**Unesaneh Tokef**" (P238) is attributed to Rabbi Amnon of Mainz, Germany. Just over 1000 years ago, he suffered unimaginable torture at the hands of the Duke of Hessen for staying true to Judaism.

As he lay dying, he composed this prayer and recited it with his congregation on the first day of Rosh Hashanah. Three days later he came to Rabbi Kalonymos ben Meshullam in a dream to teach him the words to the prayer and to request that he send it to all of Jewry and that it be inserted into the Rosh Hashanah liturgy. Rabbi Amnon's wish was carried out and soon it was also included in the Yom Kippur prayers as well.

Shulcercise:

We do a fair amount of standing, sitting and even bowing on Yom Kippur.

Rule of thumb: If the Ark is open, you should stand. The Ark's open doors reflect the open doors of Heaven & opportunity for our prayers to rise straight up.



Makes you think...

Yom Kippur is when the Jewish nation received the Second Tablets, which were given quietly, without the fanfare, thunder and lightning of the first set of Tablets.

Here's why:

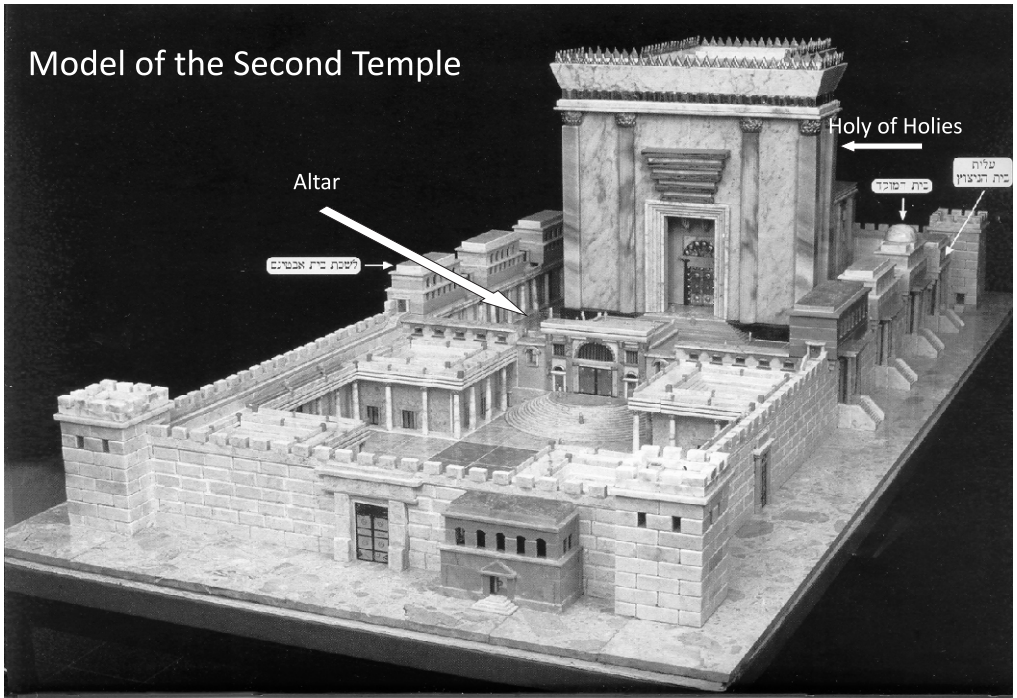
When a child is at home, you cannot always see his love for his parents. He's just content to be home. But, when he travels far away, his natural love for his parents comes to the surface. He misses his family and yearns for them.

Yom Kippur is a day of pleasure. No, not the eat-drink-be-merry kind of pleasure, but the higher pleasure of the World to Come. Yom Kippur is actually considered the most joyous day of the year, not because we're partying, but because it is the day when we realise that nothing can stand in between us and our Father in heaven.

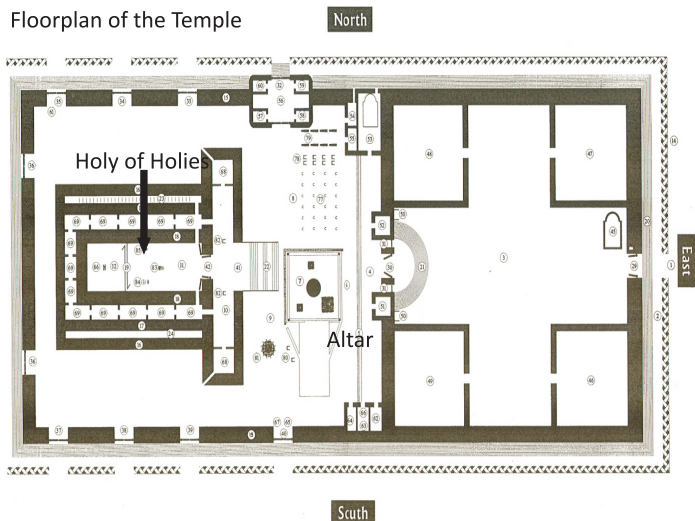
Such pleasure and joy are so intense, yet subtle that they eclipse revealed. Today is like the moment that the Second Tablets were given to our ancestors. No lighting, no thunder, no fireworks of emotion; just the still secure knowing that we and G-d are inseparable.

This is the longest section of the service. It describes everything that went on in the Temple on Yom Kippur. Here we will enjoy a fascinating historical glimpse into the real Yom Kippur experience.

Read the English, you'll find it intriguing! (P246) Please use the diagrams provided to help navigate through the story.



Floorplan of the Temple



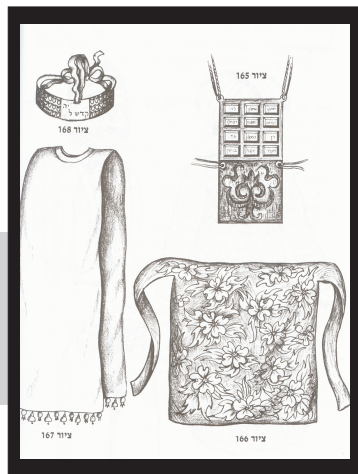
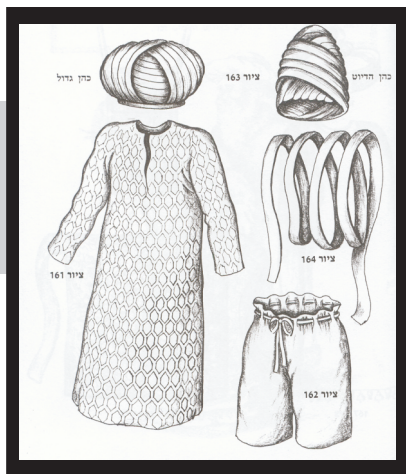
AVODAH

Holy of Holies:

Today, the Temple lives each of our hearts. Each of us is the High Priest & Yom Kippur is when we access our personal Holy of Holies, the essence of our own Soul.

The "White" Clothes

Whenever the High Priest entered the Holy of Holies, he wore the simple outfit of a regular *Kohen*.



The "Gold" clothes

The special garments, worn only by the High Priest. They include the breastplate (used to communicate messages from G-d) and the headband with G-d's name.

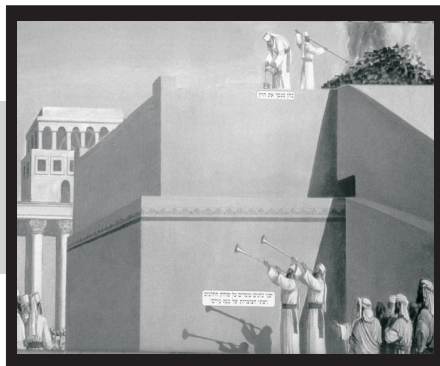


Mikveh

The *kohanim* would hold up sheets to allow the High Priest to immerse in private.

The sacrifices

The animal sacrifices were brought on the outer "copper" altar.





Ketores

The most spiritual service performed by the High Priest on Yom Kippur involved bringing the *Ketores*-incense into the Holy of Holies.

Ketores was the antidote to the Angel of death and the serum against impurity. Even the greatest angels were not allowed into the Holy of Holies when the *Kohen Gadol* was there.

Dedication to G-d

When the High Priest would announce G-d's name on Yom Kippur, the congregation would prostrate themselves fully on the ground, to show absolute dedication to G-d.

Today, we only kneel and lower our heads to the floor, but still intend to submit ourselves to G-d in the process.



Good Yom Tov!

Yom Kippur is called the greatest Yom Tov of the year.

Some people feel guilt around Yom Kippur, but you should actually feel immense joy at the opportunity that we have to self-actualise and transcend our old selves.

HOW TO

Bowing (e.g. P249)

We bow a number of times during the Yom Kippur service.

Drop to your knees, bend your head forward until your forehead touches the ground. (Some lift themselves slightly on their fists, so that only their toes and forehead touch the floor). Women simply bow their heads.

Take cover (P284)

Towards the end of the service, the *Kohanim* will bless the community. Men cover their faces with their *Talis*, because you are not supposed to look at the *kohanim* when they bless us. Ideally, you should bring your children under your *Talis* too.

If you are a *Levi*, you have the honour of washing the *Kohanim's* hands before they bless us.

Sing a long (P286)

At the end of the morning (or is it already afternoon?) service, we will joyously sing that we are certain that G-d has sealed us for a spectacular New Year. Even if you don't know the words, you should find the tune quite catchy.

LATE AFTERNOON- MINCHA

Stop everything (P302)

Mincha is the toughest of the daily prayers, because it usually occurs right in the middle of the working day. For this reason, Mincha is considered one of our most powerful prayers.

Torah Reading

Spells out the forbidden intimate relationships. Good lesson: No matter how lofty you may feel, always be on guard against inappropriate temptations.

The Haftorah

We read the entire Book of Jonah which concludes with the 13 Attributes of Compassion. The book discusses the power of *teshuvah* and how one cannot escape from G-d, as Jonah tried to do. The repentance of the people of Ninveh serves as an inspiration to us to repent, and shows us that *teshuvah* can overturn a Divine decree.

Good

investment:

Buying the honour of being called to the Torah for the Jonah *haftorah* is the key to wealth in the coming year.

Speak to the rabbi to find out more.

Penitential Prayers (P326)

Exclusive to Yom Kippur is an entire selection of *Selichos* which are recited in each of the five prayers on Yom Kippur.

Arguably the most moving of them is when we open the Ark and ask G-d to hear our prayers and not forsake us (P330).



Makes you think...

Self-pity is nothing less than an impulse to destroy yourself. And this is its script:

"This is the way you were made. These are the facts of your situation. It's bad. Worse than anybody else in the whole world. In fact, it's so bad, it's impossible to do anything about it. And therefore, you are free from any responsibility to clean it up. Nobody can blame you for anything."

Self-pity is a liar and a thief. A liar, because everyone is granted the power to clean up his own mess, if only he will try. A thief, because as long as it sits inside you, it is stealing away the days of your life.

- Tzvi Freeman, meditation based on the Rebbe's teachings

Neilah: The most unique prayer of the year, which allows us access to the essence of our Souls.

Standing room:
If you have the
strength, you
should stand for
the entire Neilah.

Homecoming

We do not recite the long confessional *al chet* in Neilah, as this is where we access the fifth level of soul, *yechida*. Here we are one with G-d; no sin is possible, no apologies necessary.

Neilah means “locked”. Most people understand this prayer as the last-minute rush before the gates are locked. Chassidus explains that Neilah means this is the moment we get locked into private chambers with G-d. Nothing can interfere with our prayers!

Open the gates of heaven (P370)

The previous Lubavitcher Rebbe, Rabbi Yosef Yitzchak Schneersohn asked, “G-d is the source of all good, whatever He does is for our good, so why the emphasis ‘Your good treasure?’ ”

“It’s all a matter of punctuation”, he explained. Move the comma to after the word “for us.” We don’t always know what is good for us, so we ask G-d for “The treasure which is **good for us.**”



HOW TO

Announce your dedication (P379)

To conclude Yom Kippur, we all announce our absolute dedication to G-d. We say “*Shema*” once. “*Boruch Shem*” three times and “*Hashem Hu Ho'Elokim*” seven times.

Victory! (P379)

In mid-Kadish, we'll sing a victory march to express our confidence that Yom Kippur has worked in our favour and G-d has blessed us with an amazing New Year.

One blast (P379)

After the singing, we blow one blast on the Shofar and all shout “Next year in Jerusalem”.

Maariv (P390)

After Neilah, we read *Tehillim* and then the weekday evening service (a real test of how much of the inspiration of Yom Kippur really lasts).

Bless the Moon (P407)

As we do each month, we say a blessing over the Moon. You need to wash your hands (three times alternating on each hand) beforehand.

And just before you eat

COMING ATTRACTIONS

Breaking the fast

Have a full Yom Tov meal (with *challah* dipped in honey) to break the fast.

Plan your Sukkah

Ideally, you should start building your *Sukkah* straight after Yom Kippur. At the very least, start planning it.

Buy a lulav

Never owned one? Well, why not try it this year? It's a funky Mitzvah for the whole family.

Sukkah decor:

Artwork is great, but guests in the *Sukkah* are the real decorations.

Diarise!

Sukkos

Starts on Sunday night, 30th September. Eat your meals in the Sukkah and shake the Lulav daily (except Shabbos).



Simchas Torah

The party starts on Sunday 7th October at 6:15 p.m.

The main event is on Monday 8th October from 6:30 p.m. and includes a smashing kids' programme.

We conclude & restart the Torah on Tuesday, 9th October. Make a

note in your diary to pop in between 10 and 12 on Friday- it definitely beats sitting in the office!

Joy!

Sukkos and *Simchas Torah* are the holidays of joy- celebrate them well!

Official opening

So, we've been in our new premises for just on a year + it's our community's barmitzvah. Sounds like a reason to celebrate, right?

Please join us on 10th December for the formal opening of the new Chabad of Strathavon!

True Holiness



One year, on the eve of Yom Kippur, as the community waited to start Kol Nidrei, the Alter Rebbe (the founder of Chabad) removed his tallis and left the Shul. The crowd waited and wondered where their Rebbe had gone. After a lengthy delay, the Rebbe finally returned and signaled for the prayers to begin.

His disciples could hardly contain their curiosity and later inquired about his strange behaviour. The Rebbe explained that a poor woman, who lived at the very edge of town had just given birth. While everyone prepared to enter the holy day in Shul, the hapless woman remained alone with nobody to care for her and her baby.

The Alter Rebbe had walked to the edge of town, chopped some wood and taken it to her ramshackle home. There, he lit a fire, cooked some food and fed the new mother and her children. Only once he was satisfied that she had been properly cared for did the Alter Rebbe return to the Shul to commence Kol Nidrei.

Now the Rebbe's actions were all apparently in violation of the laws of Yom Kippur. One cannot help but wonder how he broke such a holy day. One can only imagine what lofty spiritual heights a person of the Alter Rebbe's calibre could reach during his prayers. His Yom Kippur prayers were undoubtedly on the highest spiritual plane. Yet, helping a Jew in distress clearly outweighed such sublime spiritual rapture.

"But Rebbe," his students persisted, "Surely, you could have asked one of us to tend to the woman? Why did you have to go yourself?"

"The Rebbe smiled, "To illustrate a very important point. When there is a mitzvah to be done; when someone is in need do not rely on anybody else to do it. Do the mitzvah yourself!"

